



Swiss Government Excellence Scholarships

Postdoctoral Scholarships

Academic year: 2016-2017

Country: Pakistan

Opening of the Call: 01.08.2015

Submission Deadline: 30.09.2015

Scholarship



Swiss Government Excellence Postdoctoral Scholarships for foreign researchers

Offered by



The Swiss Government through the Federal Commission for Scholarships for Foreign Students FCS

Objectives



To enable selected applicants to undertake a postdoctoral research in one of the 10 Swiss Public Universities, the two Swiss Federal Institutes of Technology, the public teaching and research institutes and the Universities of Applied Sciences.

Universities



[University of Basel](#) / [University of Bern](#) / [University of Fribourg](#) / [University of Geneva](#) / [University of Lausanne](#) / [University of Lucerne](#) / [University of Neuchâtel](#) / [University of St. Gallen](#) / [University of Zurich](#) / [University of Lugano](#)

Federal Institutes of Technology



[Swiss Federal Institute of Technology Lausanne \(EPFL\)](#)
[Swiss Federal Institute of Technology Zurich \(ETHZ\)](#)
[Research Institutes of the ETH Domain \(PSI; WSL; EMPA; EAWAG\)](#)

Teaching and Research Institutes



[Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies \(IHEID\)](#)

Universities of applied Sciences



[University of Applied Sciences Western Switzerland](#) / [Bern University of Applied Sciences](#) / [University of Applied Sciences Northwest Switzerland](#) / [University of applied Sciences Eastern Switzerland](#) / [Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Arts](#) / [University of Applied Sciences and Arts of Southern Switzerland](#) / [The Zürcher Fachhochschule](#)

Validity



The Scholarship is only valid for a full time postdoctoral research in Switzerland. It is not valid for mixed postdoctoral research (part time in Switzerland and part time in a third country).

Target Group



Highly qualified postdoctoral researchers from all academic fields.

Duration	⇒ 12 months (starting in September) no extension possible Grant applications for stays lasting less than 9 months will not be treated as a priority. Grant applications for stays lasting less than 6 months will be rejected.
Amount and additional allowances	⇒ The scholarship amounts to a monthly payment of 3'500 Swiss Francs. ⇒ Exemption of the tuition fees (except for EPFL). ⇒ For non-EU and EFTA grantees only: Mandatory Swiss Health insurance paid by the FCS. ⇒ A lump sum for air fare for non-European grantees only (provided at the end of the scholarship). ⇒ Special 300 Swiss Francs housing allowance (paid once at the beginning of the scholarship). ⇒ 1 year half-fare public transportation card. ⇒ Counseling and various trips, dinners and sight-seeing tours organized for Swiss Government Excellence Scholarship holders.
Eligibility Criteria and specific conditions	⇒ PhD degree ⇒ There cannot be a gap of more than 5 years between the award of the PhD and the application deadline. ⇒ Applicants who are in Switzerland for more than 1 year at the beginning of the scholarship in September are not eligible. ⇒ Applicants must provide a letter (or e-mail) from a Professor from the Swiss host institution stating that they are willing to supervise the postdoctoral research. Without such a confirmation the application will be rejected. ⇒ Applicants must have a research proposal including a timeframe (this is the central piece of the application. The applicant must devote all required attention to it). ⇒ Applicants must be in command of the necessary language skills required for the postdoctoral research. ⇒ Applicants who have already benefited from a Swiss Government Excellence Scholarship are not eligible to apply for a second scholarship.
Selection Criteria	The following dimensions and selection criteria are considered mainly: ⇒ The candidate: Her/his academic profile and research capacity. ⇒ The research project: It's originality and methodological soundness. ⇒ The academic context: The quality of supervision and the potential for future academic cooperation.
Application Procedure	⇒ The application package can be obtained by e-mail from the Swiss Embassy in Islamabad. ⇒ The deadline for the submission of applications is 30.09.2015 ⇒ Applications have to be submitted in 3 sets with the indicated number copies (hard copies only). The 1 st set contains the original, signed documents and the attested translations. The other 2 sets are the copies of the 1 st set. For details see the Application Guidelines available at your contact institution (see below).
Application Time Framework	⇒ Opening of the call: 01.08.2015 ⇒ Application Deadline: 30.09.2015 ⇒ Selection Interview, ask: Swiss Embassy ⇒ Beginning of the scholarship: 01.09.2016

Application documents

(Please provide 3 sets of copies on A4 paper. Please do not staple the documents and/or put them into plastic sheets or binders).

- ⇒ The FCS 2016-2017 official application form (typed and printed). No handwritten forms will be accepted.
- ⇒ Copies of all university certificates and grade-sheets (all copies must be attested, and translated if originals are not in English, German, French or Italian. Attestations can be done by the University or a Government Officer.
- ⇒ 2 letters of recommendation from Professors in the applicants field (use exclusively the official reference form provided with the application package).
- ⇒ A complete research proposal (max. 5 pages), use exclusively the official research proposal form provided with the application package.
- ⇒ A motivation letter (max. 2 pages).
- ⇒ A full curriculum vitae with list of academic publications.
- ⇒ A copy of the confirmation from a Professor at the intended Swiss University that they are willing to supervise the Postdoctoral Research.
- ⇒ Include a short CV of your academic supervisor.
- ⇒ A health certificate (use exclusively the official health certificate provided with the application package).
- ⇒ Each application set with two copies of the passport (main page with personal data).

Contact institution for the application

- ⇒ Questions and application documents, have to be submitted at the following address:
- ⇒ Swiss Embassy in Islamabad
Street 06, Diplomatic Enclave, G-5/4, 44000 Islamabad
- E-mail: isl.scholarships@eda.admin.ch
- Tel: 0092 51 2279 291
- Web: <http://www.eda.admin.ch/islamabad>

Summing up

- ⇒ The FCS 2016-2017 official application form with photo
- ⇒ CV with list of publications
- ⇒ Motivation letter (max. 2 pages)
- ⇒ A copy of the confirmation from a professor at the intended Swiss university stating that they are willing to supervise the research (incl. a short CV)
- ⇒ 2 letters of recommendation from professors (use the FCS form only)
- ⇒ A complete and signed research proposal (max. 5 pages) using exclusively the official FCS research proposal form provided with the application package
- ⇒ Photocopies of certificates from previously attended university/colleges and diplomas with grades
- ⇒ Medical certificate (use solely the official FCS form)
- ⇒ Two copies of passport